

MANDATE 2024 | GANDHINAGAR |

SHAH AT HOME

AS THE UNION HOME MINISTER SEEKS A SECOND TERM FROM GANDHINAGAR, HE BANKS ON THE DEVELOPMENT PLANK AND GUJARATI PRIDE FOR A MASSIVE MANDATE. BUT ISSUES LIKE JOBS AND KSHATRIYA IRE THREATEN TO DENT HIS WINNING MARGIN

By Jumana Shah
in Gandhinagar

TWO DAYS BEFORE AMIT SHAH FILED HIS NOMINATION PAPERS FROM GANDHINAGAR—a seat the Union home minister first won in 2019, with a margin of 557,000-plus votes—he visited 30 voters for whom he is the designated *panna pramukh*. A *panna* is a page in the electoral rolls, each assigned a *pramukh*, or in-charge, by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) to mobilise support. "Twenty-seven confirmed that they will vote for [Prime Minister Narendra] Modiji before 10.30 am on polling day. I've requested the remaining three, who plan to travel, to reschedule their vacation," says Shah, settling down for a Gujarati meal, wife Sonal by his side, at the house of a close associate, amid campaigning the following day.